AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X EXAMINATION

MAY 2011

English Compulsory Paper I

Time allowed: 45 minutes Marks 25

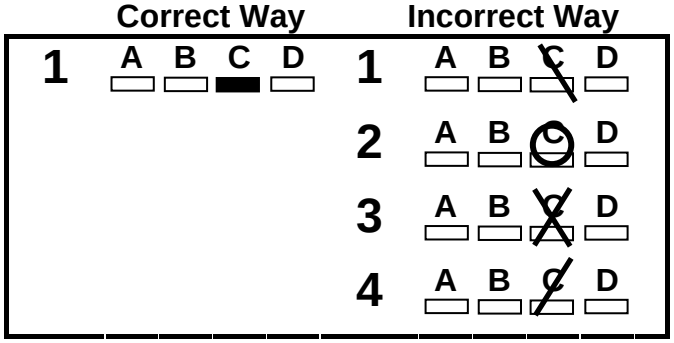
INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read each question carefully.

2. Answer the questions on the separate answer sheet provided. DO NOT write your answers on the question paper.

3. There are 100 answer numbers on the answer sheet. Use answer numbers 1 to 25 only.

4. In each question there are four choices A, B, C, D. Choose ONE. On the answer grid black out the box for your choice with a pencil as shown below.



5. If you want to change your answer, ERASE the first answer completely with a rubber, before blacking out a new box.

6. DO NOT write anything in the answer grid. The computer only records what is in the boxes.

Listening Comprehension Section

This section is 25 minutes long. In this section you will hear two recordings. Each one will be played twice.
Listen carefully to the first recording then read the first 6 questions. You will have two minutes' reading time.
The recording will then be replayed. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the recording has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three and a half minutes to pencil in your answers.

Follow the instruction on the front page of Paper I to show which of the options; A, B, C, or D you have selected for each question.

Listening Passage I
This passage is a conversation between two friends, Fawad and Sara. Fawad appreciates Sara's efforts to keep her garden beautiful.

Source: www.esl-lab.com

Now listen to the recording.

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

1. The topic of the conversation is

   A. incorrect ways of gardening.
   B. adverse effects of gardening.
   C. advantages of gardening.
   D. attitude towards gardening.

2. According to the conversation, Sara's secret of keeping a garden beautiful is to

   A. use a special gardening tool.
   B. hire a good gardener.
   C. enjoy working in the garden.
   D. have a good lawn mower.

3. Fawad is critical of Sara’s attitude because he

   A. disbelieved her secret.
   B. doubted her talent.
   C. wanted to hire a gardener.
   D. wanted to hurt her feelings.

4. What did Fawad think about gardening?

   A. One should spend more time to make a garden beautiful.
   B. One should have healthy plants in the garden.
   C. One should plan before planting trees.
   D. One should be dependent on a lawn mower.

5. Fawad's final decision after talking to Sara was that

   A. her attitude was wrong.
   B. he would hire a gardener.
   C. Sara was just crazy.
   D. farmers enjoy gardening.

6. What kind of a conversation is it?

   A. Persuasive
   B. Argumentative
   C. Narrative
   D. Descriptive

Now, we will play the second recording. It will also be played twice.

Listen carefully to the first playing, then read Questions 7 to 12. You will have two minutes' reading time. The recording will then be replayed.

When the recording has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three and a half minutes to pencil in your answers.

Listening Passage II

The passage is about one of the Sindh's famous landmarks, Chawkandi tombs and a description about its historical importance and structure.

Source: Images, Dawn

Now listen to the recording.

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

7. The basic purpose of the Chawkandi tombs was to

   A. preserve the primitive civilization.
   B. bury dead bodies.
   C. display cultural art and craft.
   D. represent the current style of architecture.

8. According to the passage, the textiles, jewellery and pottery of Sindh and Balochistan

   A. emphasize rectangular structures.
   B. reflect 18th century carvings.
   C. portray marvels of the past.
   D. share similarities of design.

9. This historical building has been named, 'Chawkandi' as it

   A. stands on four pillars.
   B. is covered with four motifs.
   C. is familiar with Sindhi art.
   D. is a four cornered shape.

10. Some of the tombs '*stand proudly in the sun*' means

    A. they are supported by four pillars.
    B. its domes have been removed.
    C. only their pillars are standing.
    D. they do not have any cover upon them.

11. The artistic display on the tombs not only represents the fine craftsmanship of the artisans but also indicates the

    A. gender of the person in the grave.
    B. designs of Gujjo and Sehwan Sharif.
    C. novelty of artistic motifs.
    D. delicate wood carvings of that time.

12. The unique designs are not limited to the architecture in Sindh region but also had a great impact on

    A. clothing, pottery and other crafts.
    B. the glorious heritage of Sindh.
    C. the intricate designs of pillars.
    D. marvels lost in the dust.

Reading Comprehension Section

You have 20 minutes of this session; you are advised to spend approximately 10 minutes on each of the given passages. This section has two reading passages.

Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions which follow:

Reading Passage I

The Leaning Tower of Pisa is the freestanding bell tower of the cathedral of the Italian city of Pisa. It is situated behind the Cathedral and it is the third structure in Pisa's Field of Miracles.

Although intended to stand vertically, the tower began leaning to the southeast soon after the onset of its construction in 1173 due to a poorly laid foundation and loose substrate that has allowed the foundation to shift.

The construction of the Tower of Pisa was performed in three stages over a period of about 200 years. Construction of the first floor of white marble began in 1173, a period of military success and prosperity.

There is controversy about the identity of the architect of the Leaning Tower of Pisa. For many years, the design was attributed to Guglielmo and Bonanno Pisano, well-known 12th century resident artists of Pisa. However, Pisano left Pisa in 1185 for Sicily.

The tower first acquired a lean after the third floor was built in 1178, due to a mere three-metre foundation set in weak, unstable subsoil. This means the design was flawed from the beginning.

Benito Mussolini started the re-construction of the tower during his rule. He ordered that the tower should be returned to a vertical position, so concrete was poured into its foundation. However, the result was that the tower actually sank further into the soil.

In 1964, the government of Italy requested aid in preventing the tower from toppling. It was however considered important to retain the current tilt, due to the vital role that this element played in promoting the tourism industry of Pisa. A multinational task force of engineers, mathematicians and historians was assigned the task. After two decades of hard work, the tower was made strong enough to prevent it from toppling.

In 1987, the tower was declared as UNESCO World Heritage Site along with neighbouring cathedral, baptistery and cemetery.

Source: Reader's Digest

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

13. The phrase '*free standing*' (line 1) means standing

A. alone.
B. without support.
C. on common land.
D. without a boundary wall.

14. According to the passage, the construction of the Pisa tower began in

A. the middle of the Field of Miracles.
B. white marble.
C. the twelfth century.
D. the period of Mussolini.

15. The construction was brought to a halt as

A. the soil needed to settle.
B. a flaw was identified in the design.
C. the war was going on.
D. the period of prosperity was over.

16. The tower started leaning because of

A. the concrete which was poured into its foundation.
B. the construction of various floors.
C. the soil which was unstable.
D. its complicated design.

17. Efforts were made so that the tower would

A. not fall down.
B. stand strongly.
C. stand protected.
D. lean to one side.

18. What is the common element between the cathedral, baptistery, cemetery and the tower?

A. All are promoting tourism equally.
B. All have been recognized by UNESCO.
C. They were constructed by Mussolini.
D. All have flaws in construction.

19. It is important to maintain the tilt so that

A. it does not fall.
B. more visitors are attracted.
C. it gets more aid.
D. neighbouring sites could be protected.

Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions which follow:

Reading Passage II

Not everyone knows but this year, 2010 was designated as 'The International Year of Biodiversity' by the United Nations which currently estimates that at least three species of plants, animals, birds, fish, insects are becoming extinct every single hour of every single day! This means something like 72 species a day, some of which have not even been identified as yet. These species are disappearing from the planet every 24 hours which is both astonishing and an extremely disturbing figure.

This is the fastest rate of species extinction since the dinosaurs and their natural world disappeared so many millions of years ago. While dinosaurs are thought to have become victims of the climate change at that time, today's extinctions are being blamed on a combination of things including loss of habitat, reduction in forest cover, expansion of cities, industrial pollution, over fishing and on changing climatic conditions too.

Back in 2002, the UN launched an ambitious plan to slow down the rate of species extinction by 2010, but the plan failed miserably. This time around, they are trying to involve commercial enterprises, particularly big businesses by pointing out to them how much potential profit there is in maintaining the biodiversity of the natural world.

For example, numerous pharmaceutical companies rely on wild plant materials for their research. However, if the same companies, who currently have to pay large amounts of money to obtain the required plant material, set up their own plant production areas, maintaining them in a natural way, they would both save money and create employment while generating a responsible attitude towards nature in the people working for them.

Furthermore, the tourist industry would reap considerable profits if beaches, coral reefs, the sea and natural sea and shore life were properly maintained, while switching to organic methods of farming can render crops more profitable than they would otherwise be. Obviously, some people consider the commercialization of the natural world to be an absolute non-starter but, if such projects can be launched in a viable manner, then they may just lead to a noticeable slow down in the loss of biodiversity which is happening right now.

Source: www.voanews.com

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

20. Who has designated the year 2010 as the International Year of Biodiversity?

A. USA
B. UK
C. UN
D. KSA

21. According to the passage, the term '*biodiversity*' stands for

A. biological control.
B. loss of flora and fauna.
C. extinction of some species.
D. variety of different species.

22. Efforts are being made to control the rate of extinction of species by involving the

A. general public.
B. biological agencies.
C. private companies.
D. natural resources.

23. The biological material needed by pharmaceutical companies for their research are mainly

A. antibiotics.
B. herbs and shrubs.
C. insects and pests.
D. animals and birds.

24. The pharmaceutical companies can help to conserve nature and generate employment by

A. increasing their potential profit.
B. developing their own plant production farms.
C. showing a responsible attitude towards nature.
D. paying a large amount to obtain plant material.

25. Which of the following may let the tourist industry earn a handsome profit?

A. Marine life and coastal surroundings
B. Setting up production plants
C. Reduction in forest cover
D. Switching to organic methods

END OF PAPER

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